Not a Boob Window...

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Not a Boob Window...

by sunnydaysma

Summary

After a month of not seeing each other Adora and Catra are finally going to be reunited! Adora was crazy excited to see Catra but will her own, and other people's, expectations get in the way of a good reunion for them after all?

(This is an addition to the universe of my previous fic, Turning a New Leaf. It's not required to read to understand this one, but I do recommend it just for some context)

Notes

oop i am back again with a lil addition to this au bc i love it so much

CW: Panic Attack

See the end of the work for more notes

It's been a month. A very long, hard month. One whole month without Catra.

Adora gets what Glimmer's been saying, she has gone her whole life without Catra (kinda), but now that she had her, it's hard to just let that go.

Glimmer doesn't understand it either. She sees Bow at least once a week, if not more. She never has to go long without being able to hug him.

Adora really misses Catra's hugs.

But it's okay now. Now she's coming to visit.

Sure, she's bringing Entrapta, and Scorpia, who's bringing Perfuma. And once Bow caught wind of this of course, everyone was invited to come.

Adora is slightly irked Bow has managed to hijack her first night with Catra, but she's sure they'll get alone time after the weekend is over. To talk. Not for that stuff. Maybe for that stuff. Only a bit.

She really does miss Catra.

They've talked every night before they go to sleep, Adora much earlier than Catra. Even falling asleep while still on call once or twice. But it's not the same.

There are no hushed whispers between tired kisses. No clothes smelling like Catra the next day. No waking up in the warm early morning sun tangled together happily. And especially no grumpy Catra turning off the alarm before curling back into the soft warmth of Adora's embrace.

Soon there will be.

Soon.

Adora wakes up on the day an hour before her alarm goes off. She has the whole day planned out perfectly.

First, she and Glimmer will pick up Bow at 11. Then they will all go over to the bowling alley to bowl. After that, they'll return to Glimmer and Adora's place for some take-out and possible drinks.

(Adora still feels weird calling Glimmer's house her place. It was her place of stay at this moment, but it wasn't her home or anything.)

It takes maybe 10 minutes to get to Bows house. Adora's up at 9, just to be sure.

It's her first time seeing Catra in a month! She has to prepare. Like showering, planning the perfect outfit, and getting Glimmer up in time which will probably take the most amount of time and effort.

Showering here still feels weird. No matter what, Adora still feels like a guest. Even when the Brightmoon family refers to the home as Adora's. Or when Angela starts acting like her parent (in a good way). Or when Glimmer complains about her slowly taking over their kitchen (Adora hasn't done that at all, the kitchen is much too large for that).

She still keeps all her toiletries in a separate bag, even though her washroom is private.

Adora looks at herself in the reflection on the glass shower wall. She really doesn't want to assume anything. But it can't hurt to be prepared?

"Just in case.." She whispers to herself as she grabs her razor.

Seeing Catra is a special thing. She wants to look her best. Which is why she's tempting fate by waking Glimmer up early to do her hair.

Nothing too fancy, just a long french braid instead of her (truly iconic) regular ponytail.

With her hair wet and smelling like citrus blend, she knocks loudly on Glimmer's door.

She hears Glimmer groan and shuffle over to the door.

"Adora, it's only 9:30. I don't need to be up for another 20 minutes at least," She speaks without opening her eyes.

"Can you do my hair for me?" Adora rushes out, suddenly nervous to ask. It's stupid, there's no reason to be anxious asking for a simple thing, but she *is*.

Glimmer's eyes open, "Can I dress you too?" At Adora's hesitance she continues, "It's my fee for the hair."

Adora nods, worried about her intentions, and Glimmer claps happily.

"Get your butt in here then!"

Oh dear, this'll be fun.

"You're wearing that?"

Adora looks at herself in the mirror. She thinks she looks fine. It's a normal outfit. A plain top under her usual red jacket paired with some jeans. Sure, the jeans make a weird noise when she walks because of how worn out they are. And maybe the top is a little loose from wear, but it fits fine. She can move in it.

"Adora, I did not do your hair nicely for that outfit. Come on." Glimmer sighs, walking out of her room and into Adora's.

Adora follows like a dutiful dog. Watching as Glimmer goes to town in her wardrobe.

"What about this?" She holds up a black sports bra.

"That's a bra?" Adora questions.

"As a top." Glimmer points out.

"Isn't that a bit much for a bowling alley? There's gonna be children there." Adora hurries to explain.

Glimmer rolls her eyes, "Like you and Catra won't be eye-fucking anyways. Fine! No bra-top."

Adora wants to ask about that eye-fucking thing...but on second thought maybe she doesn't want to know what Glimmer thinks of her sex life.

"This?" Glimmer holds up a small white top.

Adora feels her face flush. She knows why she can't wear it, but she doesn't want to tell Glimmer.

"It's uh too small?"

Glimmer lowers the arm holding the top, using the other to put on her hip, "Wanna try that excuse again? I saw you wearing this last week." She completes the threat – was it a threat? it sounded like one – with a raise of her eyebrows.

"Well, you see, I-" Only Adora doesn't know what to say. All options are bad.

Glimmer shakes her head.

"You'll be able to see my bra through it." Yeah, good enough. It's not a lie, but not the full truth. A half-truth. Glimmer will accept that.

"Change bras." She points out like Adora is being dumb and she can't understand why.

"No. I can't. I have to wear this one bra." Adora nods seriously.

"Whyyyyy-" Glimmer drags out, before realizing why exactly Adora won't change her bra. Her face goes blank, Adora fears for the words about to come out of Glimmer's mouth, "Adora. I'm going to say this as nicely as I can."

Adora nods seriously, her face burning in embarrassment. She resembles a firetruck at this point.

"I already know enough about your sex life after that present I had the displeasure of seeing," Oh gods, Adora wants to sink into the bed she's sitting on and never return, "I do not want to know more. Please!" Glimmer groans scrunching her eyes and holding her hands out like a prayer, "Please! Keep it down. I don't need to hear your, or Catra's moans. Ever."

"Ok. Yeah. Totally. We'll just uhm yeah. Keep it-you know-down. The present-thing-was a little like joke? Like-"

"Nope. I don't wanna know." Glimmer covers her eyes like a child, "Just wear the black tank top with those jeans and a jacket." She says before leaving the room.

Adora nods to no one. Still impossibly embarrassed. The present *was* a joke. A bit of a joke. 60% a joke. Maybe 30%. But still! A joke!

Adora gets up slowly to look at the top Glimmer was talking about. It was small. Real small. But black. And thick enough so it won't show her bra. Small winnings.

Adora drives to get Bow.

Glimmer can drive but...she's awful. Too fast. Takes turns too sharply. Switches lanes without proper checking. Overall, it's a near-death experience to get into the passenger's seat with her driving. It's shocking that she passed her driver's test at all.

Driving is easy to Adora. She does it all the time. It's a stress reliever for her.

Today though...not so much.

Her hands shake. Her heart hammers against her chest. She can feel cold sweat dripping down her back. There's probably a sweat stain on her seat.

"Hey," Glimmer cautiously starts, "Everything ok?" She turns down the music so that they can only hear the hum of the car.

"Uhhh not really?" Adora whimpers out and tears start to cloud her vision.

"Ok, let's pull over then."

"But Bow?" The tears are falling. They're falling!

"Bow can wait. Let's pull over."

Adora nods and pulls over onto the side of the street. Thankfully there aren't many cars on the road today or she's sure she would have hit one.

"Ok, let's break this down." Glimmer reaches over to unbuckle Adora's seat belt and taking her hands off the steering wheel, holding them in hers.

"I'm worried." Adora whimpers out over the sound of her breathing.

"About?"

"I don't know," Her words getting caught on her sob, "Everything."

"Let's try and break it down okay?"

Adora nods, trying her best to slow her breathing back to normal, "I'm worried about seeing people. I haven't seen them in a while

and I want them to think I'm doing good. I want them to like me."

"Adora, we all love you."

"I know! That's why this is so stupid!" She slams her head back against the seat.

Glimmer thinks for a moment. "Does it have to do with seeing Catra specifically?"

Adora stays silent.

"You've been hesitant talking about her lately."

"What if she doesn't like me anymore?" She whispers head hung low.

"Oh, Adora," Glimmer says in a sad tone.

"I know. I know. It's dumb. And stupid. And I really shouldn't be thinking it but I do and it sucks."

"Adora, that's totally a normal thing to be worried about. I get worried all the time that Bow will stop liking me, and I see him all the time. But you've got to understand," Glimmer shakes her shoulder so that Adora will look at her. "Catra's like totally in love with you. I don't know her very well but from what I've heard, she doesn't talk to anyone the way she talks to you. She's softer, more kind, it's honestly unnerving sometimes."

Adora huffs out a laugh. It is weird to see the almost always curt Catra turn into mush around her. It's weird and endearing.

"I know. I know she loves me but sometimes it's hard. To shut out the voices."

"You can always get me. We both know I'm louder than all of them." Glimmer jokes nudging her.

"Yeah, don't I know it."

"Now!" She claps her hands together, "Let's go get Bow. And then bowling!"

Adora hastily wipes the rogue tears on her face before putting the car back into drive. She's got this.

On second thought, perhaps not.

Catra looks good. Too good. Good enough that Adora feels silly thinking this outfit would even hold a candle to the standards Catra was setting.

To be fair no one else is even remotely close to being as dressed up as Catra. But that doesn't matter. Catra commands the room. Well, the bowling alley. Which is filled with families, with children. And definitely not the place for Adora to be staring with such blatant intention.

"Hey Adora," Catra greets as Adora approaches the alley they're using.

Gods, how much Adora missed hearing Catra say that in person.

She doesn't even say hello back, rushing the last couple of feet and pulling Catra into a crushing hug. Shoving her face in the curve of her neck, trying to soak up as much *Catra* as she can. Squeezing and lifting Catra up a bit.

"Missed you," She whispers into Catra's neck.

Catra giggles (giggles!), "Missed you too."

Adora puts her down but makes no move to separate. She can see Glimmer and Bow walk by her to greet Scorpia and Perfuma, but she doesn't care. She doesn't care that families are watching. She's too busy thinking *OMG Catra. I'm touching Catra. Catra's here!*

"Hey," Catra whispers into her ear, "I'm loving the hug but I really wanna kiss you. Like totally been on my mind for weeks now. We can continue to hug lat-"

Adora breaks her off with a kiss. It's not hot, or messy, or wet. It's a meaningful one. Filled with love and happiness and bliss. Completely appropriate for the children to see. Maybe not small children though.

Adora can't help but smile into it. She just can't stop smiling. She's missed Catra so much it's hard to think about. It's almost surreal to think they're together again.

"Think of the children!" Glimmer, uncaring as per usual, shouts at them after they take a bit too long to separate.

"I'm going to kill Sparkles," Catra growls against Adora's lips.

Adora giggles, trying to brush off the feeling of heat traveling in her veins at the deep tone in Catra's voice, "Please don't."

Catra just rolls her eyes, and Adora takes this time to really look at her outfit.

Black skinny jeans cling to her legs, small rips on her knees, a small chain is hooked against her belt loops. A small amount of mid-drift peeks through between her pants and crop top. Silver jewelry jingles around her wrist, sparkling rings glisten in the shitty Bowlerama lighting.

Adora's eyes stop on her top. Where her top isn't, more accurately.

There's a window. A boob window. Catra's wearing a boob window. And a sultry smirk to go with it.

"You like?" She jokes, sickeningly sweet in tone. Almost as if she's mocking Adora (which she most certainly is)

"Uh....." Adora's eyes are stuck at the small amount of cleavage poking through the top, and her brain can't catch up.

A high squeaky laugh greets her lack of response. Adora's really missed that laugh.

"I'll take that as a yes?"

Adora nods quickly, "It's definitely a yes. Like wow. Oh, wow."

"Come on, hotshot." Catra taps her jaw, signaling it to close, "Let's go bowl shall we?"

Adora nods mutely, watching shamelessly at Catra's ass as she walks away. Even with the ugly muted purple and yellow bowling shoes, she's gorgeous.

It's going to be a long day.

Adora wins the second round of bowling.

Everyone got very lucky that Adora was too distracted by the swell of Catra's ass as she bowled to actually bowl properly. Catra teased her with only her face, sending knowing smirks and raised eyebrows Adora's way every time she went up to bowl.

Adora excused herself to the washroom to calm down before pulling herself together for the second round.

(She had to ignore Catra bowling, and subsequently, the way her jeans perk up her ass perfectly, for the rest of the outing. At least she won for her efforts.)

She wins by quite a lot, turns out she's actually pretty good at bowling once her brain is back in her skull.

Everyone agrees 2 rounds of bowling is enough exercise for the day. Adora could do more, she isn't totally oblivious to the way

Catra's been staring at her arms, but she's hungry and really tired of getting dirty looks from the parents nearby.

She drives Glimmer back to their house. Bow, for some odd reason, chose to ride with Seahawk and Mermista over them. Glimmer seems only slightly upset, which means she's pouting sadly in the passenger seat.

Adora's not that happy either, Catra is riding with Scorpia and Perfuma over her. Not over her, Scorpia needed the directions and Perfuma was busy doing...something...Adora wasn't paying attention. (Catra was smirking as she said it, curving her body just slightly inwards so that someone Adora's height—Adora actually—could see almost right down her top).

"Why are you still horny? I know you and Catra have phone sex, like every night." Glimmer says as Adora starts up the car.

"What!?" Adora flounders, while also trying to back out of the parking lot, "We do not!"

Glimmer looks up from her phone to raise her eyebrows at Adora.

"We don't! We talk every night, yeah, but we're not always having, you know, *that*,"

"Gods, Adora, just say sex!" Glimmer groans, not sounding upset at all. Adora thinks she enjoys seeing her struggling. That menace probably has a diary filled with all of Adora's "lesbian pain" that she reads every night for fun.

"Sex! We do not have phone sex every night." She hisses out, impossibly embarrassed.

Glimmer isn't totally incorrect. Adora and Catra *do* have phone sex a lot, but not more than a usual couple. Maybe like 2 or 3 times a week, 4 at most. But they talk every day! It's just barely the majority of the time. And Adora is always sure she's being as quiet as possible.

Glimmer rolls her eyes, "I just want to say, tone it down for my mom. Who knows, she might make Catra sleep in another room or something."

Adora's racing thoughts stop, like someone pulled the emergency brakes on them. "She might?"

"Yeah, you guys are dating. None of you can get pregnant, but she's still pretty stern about these things sometimes." Glimmer shrugs, used to her mother being protective like that.

Adora still doesn't get it. Her mother (ex-mother?) didn't blink at Jack sleeping over and vise versa. And while Angela is taking over the role of Adora's parental figure, it still feels weird to actually be parented by her.

She must go oddly silent since she can now hear the hum of the car running, and the squeaks of the brake as they pull into the driveway.

"Don't stress. If she was going to do that, she would have told you already." Glimmer reassures her.

Adora nods, and nods and nods. She really doesn't want to get a sex talk from Angela, but from what Glimmer had just said, she might actually get one tonight.

"Let's just go eat? Think about the good food. Throw away all thoughts of my mother. We're having fun!" Glimmer tells her. Funny that she has to tell Adora they're having fun.

"Yeah, fun, wahoo," It's said with such a lack of emotion even Adora cringes.

"I'm going to forget you said that." Glimmer laughs quickly and then hops out of the passenger seat.

Adora takes one final deep breath before following her out.

Angella and Micah don't greet them at the door, Adora suspects Glimmer sent them off. Which isn't surprising, she practically drags the group to the basement (how the house gets larger every time Adora enters it is magical).

The basement opens up to a large movie room, a small movie theatre at this size. Completed with the popcorn machines and candy corner. Several large leather sofa's make rows (only 2 but the sheer amount of size to get that many 3 person sofas in a room is still astonishing), Adora notices they have the pull part to flip up the bottom as well.

Glimmer and Bow make quick work of turning the front 2 sofa's around to make a circle.

"Ok, now, food," Glimmer huffs, the sofa's heavier than they appeared.

"I'm cool with anything," Catra announces flopping down and sprawling out on one of the couches, pulling Adora down with her. Adora can see the look Glimmer is giving her, but she can suck it up. She's had to endure Bow and her for the past month being all lovey-dovey in front of her face, Glimmer can last.

"Me too," Adora lets out in a short breath, squirming around to try and get comfortable on the couch with Catra. She's left lying on her back as Catra lays on her chest. She's like a nice, warm, comfortably heavy blanket.

"Hey," Catra whispers. Her face is so close, Adora can see the tiny freckles dotted along her cheeks. She's so cute.

"You're really cute." She whispers back, unable to hold the praise in.

Catra rolls her eyes, "I'm not cute," She grumbles against Adora's chest.

Adora giggles, full out laughing when the movement jostles Catra's head around. Catra lifts her head off her chest with a pout.

"Sorry, you're just cute," Adora says sounding in no way sorry at all.

Catra huffs, but makes no remark on being called cute this time. She's still pouting though.

"Why the long face," Adora frowns dramatically.

Catra makes a weird motion with her mouth and Adora can't help but giggle again, even if it disrupts Catra's head.

"Ok, ok," She murmurs as she cranes her neck to kiss Catra sweetly. It hurts her neck, and she's sure Catra isn't comfortable either, but she'd never pass up kissing Catra.

They get a couple of blissful seconds to themselves before Glimmer's obnoxious retching ruins the mood.

Adora opens her eyes to see Catra's nostrils flaring and an angry-looking Glimmer standing above them, still making the vomit noises. Everyone else looks like they couldn't care less. Perfuma is looking away respectively, Scorpia is looking at Perfuma, Mermista and Seahawk are nowhere to be found, and Bow is cooing at them. Weird.

"Yes?" Adora clears her throat.

"We've sent Seahawk and Mermista to get Japanese food," Glimmer says in a low tone.

"Mhm, thanks," Adora happily replies. Catra looks like she might attack Glimmer soon if she doesn't leave.

"Mhm, mhm," Glimmer high-pitched hums, "Remember, this is a public setting. Cool the fuck off." She finishes with an aggressive finger point before leaving again.

"She needs to blow off some steam," Catra whispers kind of jokingly.

"Ugh," Adora groans, "Please don't give me that mental image. Glimmer is *relentless*. All she wants to talk about is sex, or looking sexy, or sexting, or asking me how to take nudes. Where the fuck did she get the idea that I take nudes?" Adora whisper rants.

Catra chuckles, "It could be because you actually do take them."

"Yeah, but she doesn't know that."

"Adora, babe, sweetums, Glimmer is not that dumb. She obviously knows you take nudes because you're in a long-distance relationship with me. Not to mention, she's taken them before for you."

"No, she hasn't" Adora's lost.

Catra looks lost too, "Yeah, you told me she took that bikini photo of you?"

If Adora wasn't already blushing, which she most definitely was, she'd be burning right now. "That isn't a nude, I was wearing something..." She mumbles, not really believing the words coming out of her mouth.

Catra raises her eyebrows, "Adora. You were barely wearing a *thing*. That photo still haunts my dreams."

Oh. Adora didn't know that. She never thought Catra completely forgot about it, but to hear she thinks of it all the time? That it haunts her in a good way? That's an ego boost.

"Get that dopey look off your face, loser," Catra scolds sounding far too fond.

"Never. You *like* me," Adora teases.

"Correction, I *love* you," Catra teases back.

Adora's brain goes blissfully blank. It's so nice to hear that in person again.

Mermista and Seahawk bursting through the door, Seahawk already singing a shanty he—presumably—made up about Japanese food.

Regrettably, eating meant they'd have to detangle themselves from each other and get up off the couch. Catra's hair was squashed on one side, and Adora's fly-aways had long escaped the woven braid. Catra's cute frown, however, stayed the same.

They ate quickly, having silent conversations between themselves while the others caught up some more about what they'd been doing in the past month. Adora cared about her friend's lives, but right now she couldn't even try to pay attention to them talking.

Catra was giving her this look. It sent shivers down her spine, tingly shivers filled with both glee and fear.

It was a predatory look, one Catra sent her a lot during their movie nights back in the dorm. Adora barely remembers the plot of any of the movies they watched. They were a bit distracted back then.

Adora stops chewing, her brain too caught up with thinking of what's going to happen next to be able to concentrate on chewing.

Catra must want to have sex, she wouldn't send that look otherwise. Or maybe Adora is misreading the look? It's happened before. But what if Catra *really does* want to have sex? What then? Adora feels too jittery, too anxious, to do that tonight. She needs a night of basking in each other's presence after being apart for so long, with clothes on. She just wants to hang out with Catra, maybe make out a little, but that's it.

But what if she disappoints Catra? That's not good. Catra's been expecting this for like a month now, and who was Adora to deprive her of it?

She's no longer hungry. Her stomach is getting full of knots, there's no way she'd be able to fit anything else in there with

them. She doesn't even want to try, she's sure she'll puke it all up.

"Hey," Catra scoots closer so she can talk without the others overhearing, "You okay?"

"Yeah, of course. Why wouldn't I be?" Adora tensely laughs.

"You wanna head upstairs?" Catra asks.

Adora's too stuck in her head to see the concerned look on Catra's face. Her mind has assumed the worst of that proposition.

"Sure," She squeaks out.

Catra nods and grabs her hand to escort her to her room. Adora feels like she's underwater. Her hearing has gone all wonky, she can barely register what Catra is saying to Glimmer, and her vision is off, for she can't register the matching looks of worry on Glimmer and Catra's face.

"Come on, lead the way," Catra prompts as they leave the movie room.

Adora nods and leads them up to her room. Again, the walk is long due to the sheer size of Glimmer's house, but it isn't filled with any fun banter like before. It's tense, and that's only stressing Adora out more.

She stops in front of her door, making no moves to open it.

"This it?" Catra asks and at Adora's nod, she opens the door. Catra pulls a dazed Adora in behind her, locking the door after they're in.

Adora's suddenly aware that they're alone, *alone* alone, for the first time that day.

"Soooo," Catra drawls, adding that rasp that drives Adora up instantly. Usually drives her up instantly. "Want to give me the

tour?" It's totally rhetorical, Adora's heard the line before, and she doesn't know what to do about that.

"Uhm, there's the washroom, the bed, my dresser. The end?" Adora's voice shakes. She can't think about a tour right now.

Her mind can't escape the expectations Catra has for this night, that even Glimmer has for it. She doesn't want to disappoint them, but she just can't get her mind to shut up.

"I'm gonna use the washroom," Adora shouts before speed walking into the washroom's doorframe. She ignores Catra's question of concern before shutting the door. She's dully aware that it slammed, but it wasn't able to come through over the rushing of her blood in her ears.

She walks across the cold tile floor, over to the walk-in shower. She shuts herself in it carefully; the last thing she wants to do is break Angella's glass door.

Unfortunately, the echo in the shower just makes her ragged breathing *louder*. Her hands shake as she runs them through her hair hastily. The previously calming motion doing nothing to help her relax.

She doesn't know why she's freaking out over this. It's so unbelievably *stupid*. She likes sex! She likes having sex! With Catra! So why is she suddenly having a panic attack over the prospect of it?

She wishes she could hear Catra banging on the door. Catra's words of comfort. Just feel Catra. But she can't.

"Ok, ok, ok, ok, you're okay, nothing to freak out over, you're fine, you're doing great," She mutters to herself, her voice cutting off at the end with a sob. Great. Now she's crying.

Her brain's too loud. The bees buzzing, swarming, stinging her brain again and again and again. She can't escape them, can't stop them.

A loud bang pulls through the buzzing and Adora shoves her head into her knees to escape the noise. She just wants quiet.

"Hey, hey, hey," A soft voice joins the angry buzzing. Soft hands rest upon hers that are still clenched in her hair. The hands pull hers away from ripping out her scalp, moving rest on a warm lap, the thumbs rubbing slow circles on her palms.

"Hey, baby," At this Adora finally looks up.

Catra looks worried. Her eyebrows are knitted, and her face is twitching with the stress of holding a blank face. Adora instantly feels worse. She did this. She worried her.

"I-" Adora hiccups, her breathing still too quick to even speak a word.

"Shh, let's breathe first, okay?" Catra nods until Adora nods with her. "Follow me," Catra lifts her hands to rest on her chest (a distant part of Adora's brain focuses on the fact that she's touching the boob window).

They sit like this for...Adora doesn't know how long. Long enough for her breathing to have calmed down enough so that she can talk.

"I'm sorry," Is the first thing she says.

"No," Catra separates her right hand from hers to brush back her sweaty bangs that fell out of the braid in her scrambling, "There's nothing to be sorry for."

"But there is," Adora's eyes well up with tears again, "I'm ruining our night together,"

Catra wipes away the tears that escape, "You haven't ruined anything. Adora," She lifts her chin to make eye contact, "Is this about us having sex?"

Adora shrugs, "Kinda, yeah. I know it's dumb to stress over something that's supposed to be fun, but I am, and I don't know how to stop."

"We stop it by removing it. Adora, we don't need to have sex tonight if you don't want to. I'm perfectly happy, ecstatic even, to just cuddle in our pyjamas and watch a movie," Catra strokes along her cheek.

"No touching?" Adora pleads.

"No touching," Catra whispers back, promising her.

Adora exhales deeply, calmer now that she knows sex is off the table, "Ok,"

"Good. Now let's continue this conversation *not* in a shower." Catra scrunches her nose in disgust.

It's obnoxiously cute to Adora, and she lets out a pathetic little giggle at the sight.

"Wait? Continue?" Her giggling stops.

"Yeah, you're not done explaining this. Come on,"

Catra helps pull her up and dumps her on the bed before moving to the closet. "Which one is your pyjamas?" Adora points mutely at the bottom left drawer. Catra nods and gets to work.

Adora stays silent as Catra digs, running her hands over the scratchy but soft fabric of the duvet to ground herself. She's worried, not anxious anymore, but worried about this conversation. The hardest part of explaining her anxiety is actually *explaining* it.

It's so irrational, sometimes she even thinks it's dumb. But knowing it's irrational doesn't help any. She doesn't want Catra to think she's dumb, or messed up, or fucked in the head cause she freaks out over stupid things.

"These good?" Catra turns, holding a top Adora instantly recognizes. She remembers telling Catra, once *maybe* twice, that it's her favourite sleep top.

It's perfectly worn-in, the blue soft, almost white from all the washing and wearing. The texture is smooth and comforting in a way that Adora struggles to explain. The smell of the laundry detergent her mother used has long since been washed out, replaced by Angella's fresh linen smell. It's so much better that way.

"That's good," Adora smiles, touched by the care in Catra's actions.

Catra helps her change, but not in a sexy way. Adora almost feels like she's broken her arm and Catra's helping her because she can't. It's intimate, slow, and tender like Catra wants to move as slow as possible for Adora's comfort. They both don't mention the intentional choice of Adora's bra, Catra just throws it on the ground without a word.

Adora doesn't like sleeping in pants, so once her top is changed she gets under the covers and waits for Catra.

Catra stands still for a second, pondering, before retracing her steps to Adora's closet to grab a top for herself.

She looks criminally cute in Adora's sleep top. It's swarming her, the bottom hem falling just past the curve of her butt where it meets her thigh. When she moves Adora can catch a small peek at her underwear. Which aren't lingerie.

Huh, maybe Catra wasn't as into sex tonight as Adora previously expected.

Catra settles in next to her in the covers, completely ignoring the large amount of space on her side of the bed and cuddling right up to Adora. Adora's head stays supported by Catra's shoulder as they twist into lying down, Adora's body curving against Catra's.

Before they get too comfortable though, Adora quickly reaches towards the side of the bed to grab her stuffed animal, Swift Wind, to help calm her some more.

"This is nice," She happily mumbles into Catra's neck arch where it meets her shoulder.

"Yeah," Catra kisses the top of her head lovingly, "You okay to talk about it now?"

Adora nods. She fiddles with Swift Winds hair as she thinks of the best way to phrase it.

"Glimmer said-"

"Glimmer?"

"Shh, no interrupting,"

"Right, sorry,"

Adora closes her eyes, "Glimmer said something this morning about keeping quiet, I can't remember specifically. But it just got me thinking like, everyone thinks were gonna like fuck or whatever tonight. And sure, that's fine, it made me a bit uncomfortable but whatever. But then it looked like you wanted to and I didn't really want to but I didn't want to disappoint you or lower your expectations because we hadn't seen each other in like a month and you probably had been missing it and-"

"Adora, breathe,"

Adora takes in a gasping breath, not fully aware she was even breathing that hard before.

"Sorry,"

"No need to apologize."

"I think I just felt pressured tonight."

"Why?"

"I don't know. It had been so long since we saw each other, it just felt like that's what was supposed to happen."

"Adora, there's no right or wrong way to be in a relationship. Well, there is, but that's a different thing. For us, there's no right or wrong. We make up the rules. Nothing has to happen because other people expect it to, things happen for us because we want them to."

"I know, but sometimes my brain likes to play tricks on me."

"My brain plays tricks on me too, it's okay. To be honest I just wanted to hang out with you tonight without Sparkles. I didn't call you up here for sex, I could tell you were having a moment and I thought it be better if we were in private."

"You did?" Adora feels shocked. She really shouldn't, Catra's always been really good at reading her, but that type of care always shocked her.

"Yeah. I thought it would help."

Adora breathes quickly out of her nose, "It would have if I wasn't so freaked out."

"Shhh, no Adora criticism allowed."

Adora giggles into Catra's shoulder, breathing in her scent. It's a nice scent. She's missed it.

"I've really missed cuddling you like this." Catra quietly says after a peaceful moment.

Adora looks up, "Really?"

"Don't get me wrong, Scorpia gives nice hugs, but cuddling you is so much better." Catra finishes with a squeeze of Adora.

"That's good. I missed this too."

Adora lets her eyes unclench and rest shut instead.

She feels calm once again. So easily calm. The calm where she feels like she'll never be anxious or panicked again. She thinks about how her body feels now. How her toes are tingly, and her fingers touch the worn fabric of her top on Catra's skin.

She feels Catra slide down so that they face each other and she runs her fingers over Adora's face slowly, feeling out the groves in her skin. Coming right up in her face to whisper,

"Now what movie are we watching?"

End Notes

i just cant stop with this au seriously someone get me help

also...i've decided to try out tumblr so if yall wanna check that out its @sunnydaysma !! very thankful ive picked a weirdly obscure nickname for myself

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